Prompting Matters

Start with a good question. Then give AI what it needs.

START WITH A GOOD QUESTION

Use what you learned in Questions Matter. Then give AI the information and instructions it needs with these four moves.

01 **SHARE YOUR SITUATION**
Tell AI who you are, who the work is for, what you are working on, and why. Do not make it guess.

02 **GIVE IT THE MATERIAL**
Include the actual draft, notes, assignment, rubric, numbers, or source you want it to use. Share only what the task needs.

03 **DESCRIBE THE ANSWER YOU WANT**
Specify the format, length, tone, and what to skip. Give an example when it would help.

04 **ONE JOB AT A TIME**
Break big work into steps. Ask for the next step and say where AI should stop. Review each part before moving on.

A REUSABLE OUTLINE

I am working on **[task]** for **[audience or purpose]**.
Use **[material]**. Help me **[specific next step]**.
Give me **[format]**, with **[limits]**.
Stop after **[step]** so I can review.

PUT IT TOGETHER

“I’m preparing a history presentation for my class. Here are my notes and the rubric. Suggest three possible main arguments in a short list. Use only these notes. Wait for me to choose before making an outline.”

A quick factual question: just ask. Real work: share your situation, material, and desired answer. A big project: work one job at a time.

A prompt is a briefing, not magic words.

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